

Appointment, Cancellation and Payment Policy

How booking, cancelling, rescheduling and paying work at Bright Smile Dental

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Sample content: Bright Smile Dental is a fictional practice. This document was written for a software demonstration and is not medical advice.

About this policy

This policy explains the rules Bright Smile Dental follows for booking appointments, cancelling or moving them, arriving late, missed appointments and paying for treatment. It applies to all patients, whether they book through the website chat assistant or by phone.

Treatment prices are not listed in this document. Current prices for each treatment are shown on the Services page of the Bright Smile Dental website, and the chat assistant can tell you the current price of any treatment.

How to book an appointment

Appointments at Bright Smile Dental can be booked in two ways:

- Through the chat assistant on the website, at any time of day. The assistant shows real available times and books the appointment straight away.
- By phone on +44 20 7946 0123, Monday to Friday, 9:00am to 5:00pm.

Appointments are available Monday to Friday between 9:00am and 5:00pm, starting on the hour or half hour. Appointments can be booked up to 90 days ahead. A treatment must finish by 5:00pm, so longer treatments have earlier latest start times. For example, a 90-minute appointment can start no later than 3:30pm.

Appointment lengths

Each treatment has a fixed appointment length. The appointment length is the time reserved in the dentist's diary, including time to explain the treatment and answer questions.

Treatment	Appointment length
Check-up and clean	30 minutes
Dental filling	30 minutes
Tooth extraction	30 minutes
Teeth whitening	60 minutes
Root canal treatment	90 minutes
Dental implant	90 minutes

Some treatments need more than one appointment. Root canal treatment sometimes needs two visits, and dental implant treatment takes several visits over a number of months. The dentist will explain how many visits you need before treatment starts.

Choosing a dentist

You can ask for a particular dentist when you book. If you have no preference, Bright Smile Dental will offer the earliest available time with any dentist who provides that treatment. If you start a course of treatment with one dentist, the practice will try to keep you with the same dentist for the rest of that course.

Booking confirmation

When an appointment is booked, Bright Smile Dental confirms the date, time, dentist and treatment. Appointments booked through the chat assistant are confirmed on screen immediately, and the assistant reads the details back to you before booking so you can correct any mistakes.

Please check the confirmation carefully. If any detail is wrong, contact the practice or ask the chat assistant to change it.

How Bright Smile Dental finds your appointment

Bright Smile Dental identifies patients by their mobile phone number. To view, move or cancel an appointment, you will be asked for the phone number you used when you booked.

If you have created an account on the Bright Smile Dental website and are logged in, your appointments are linked to your account and you do not need to give a phone number.

For your privacy, the practice will not confirm or discuss an appointment with someone who cannot give the phone number it was booked with.

Cancelling or moving an appointment

You can cancel or move an appointment free of charge if you give at least 24 hours' notice. Appointments can be cancelled or moved through the chat assistant at any time, or by phone during opening hours.

When you move an appointment, your original time is kept until the new time is confirmed. If the new time you want is no longer available, your original appointment stays exactly as it was.

Notice given	What happens
24 hours or more	No charge. The appointment can be cancelled or moved freely.
Less than 24 hours	Please still let us know. A charge is not normally made the first time, but repeated short-notice cancellations may mean a deposit is needed for future bookings.
No notice (missed appointment)	A missed appointment charge of 30 pounds may apply.

Cancelled appointments are released straight away so that another patient can use the time.

Arriving late

Please arrive five to ten minutes before your appointment. If you are running late, call the practice so the dentist knows.

If you arrive more than 15 minutes late, there may not be enough time left to complete the treatment safely. In that case the dentist may carry out part of the treatment or ask you to rebook. Arriving more than 15 minutes late without letting the practice know may be treated as a missed appointment.

Missed appointments

A missed appointment is one where the patient does not attend and does not give any notice. A missed appointment charge of 30 pounds may apply.

Before making any charge, Bright Smile Dental will always contact the patient first to check that they are alright. The charge is not applied when a patient missed an appointment because of an emergency or illness.

Patients who miss three appointments in a row may be asked to pay a deposit when booking future appointments.

Treatment plans and estimates

Before any treatment beyond a check-up and clean, the dentist gives you a written treatment plan. The treatment plan lists the recommended treatment, any reasonable alternatives, the number of appointments needed and the total cost.

The cost on a treatment plan is fixed for the treatment described. If the dentist finds during treatment that something different is needed, they will stop, explain why, and agree any change with you before continuing.

Paying for treatment

Payment at Bright Smile Dental is taken on the day of treatment, at the end of each appointment. The practice accepts:

- Debit and credit cards, including contactless payments.
- Cash.

- Bank transfer, arranged in advance with the practice team.

Cheques are not accepted.

For treatment that runs over several appointments, such as dental implants, payment is taken in stages. The treatment plan shows how much is due at each stage.

Payment plans

For treatment costing more than 500 pounds, Bright Smile Dental can spread the cost over several months. Payment plans are arranged with the practice team before treatment begins. Ask at reception, or ask the chat assistant to note that you are interested, and the team will talk you through the options.

Deposits

Bright Smile Dental may ask for a deposit when booking:

- Long or multi-visit treatments, such as dental implants.
- Appointments for patients who have missed several previous appointments.

A deposit is taken off the cost of the treatment. It is refunded in full if the appointment is cancelled with at least 24 hours' notice.

Refunds

If you are unhappy with a treatment, please speak to the dentist first. If a treatment needs to be adjusted or redone because of a problem with the work, Bright Smile Dental will do this without charge. Refunds are considered case by case through the practice complaints procedure.

Dental insurance

Bright Smile Dental is a private practice and does not bill insurance companies directly. Patients with dental insurance pay for their treatment at the practice and then claim the cost back from their insurer. The practice provides an itemised receipt and will complete an insurer's claim form if you bring it. More detail is in the Insurance, Privacy and Practice Policies document.